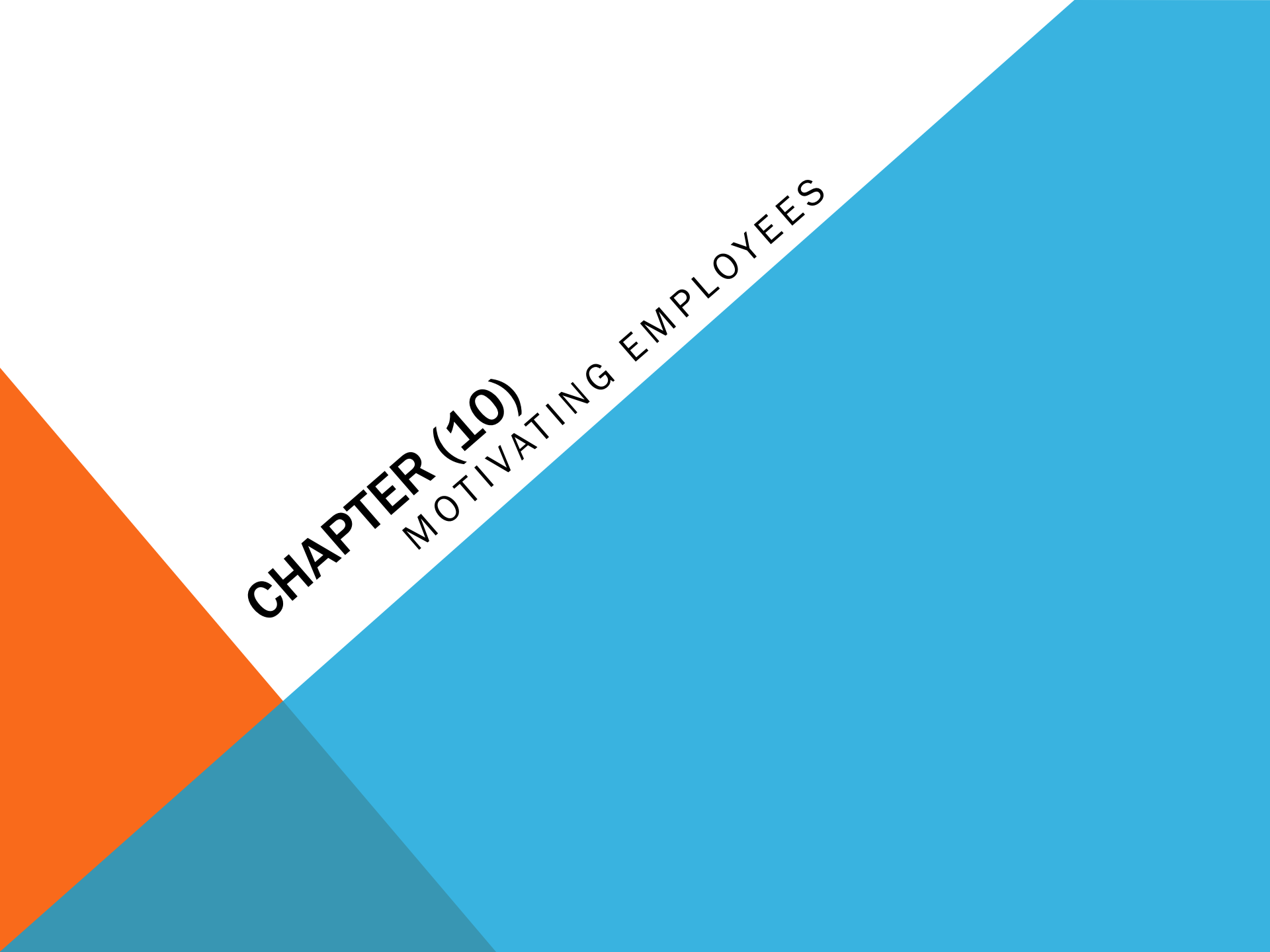




CHAPTER (10)

MOTIVATING EMPLOYEES

INTRODUCTION

The term motivation describes *why* a person does something. It is the driving force behind human actions.

Motivation causes you to act in a way that gets you closer to your goals.

Motivation also involves factors that direct and maintain goal-directed actions. Although, such motives are rarely directly observable. As a result, we must often find the reasons why people do the things that they do based on observable behaviors.

Its important to learn the types of motivation that exist and how we use them in our everyday lives.



DEFINITION

Motivation is the forces acting either on or within a person to initiate behavior. It is the desire to act in service of a goal.

Motivation is the process that starts, directs and sustains goal oriented behaviors. It includes the biological, emotional, social, and cognitive forces that drive behavior in the direction of meeting needs or achieving objectives



TYPES OF MOTIVATION

Extrinsic motivation

Arises from outside of the individual and often involves external rewards such as trophies, money, social recognition, or praise.

Extrinsic motivation is a motivation that is driven by external rewards. These can be tangible, such as money or grades, or intangible, such as praise or fame.

People who are extrinsically motivated will continue to perform a task even though it might not be in and of itself rewarding. For example, they will do something at their job that they don't find enjoyable in order to earn a wage.

TYPES OF MOTIVATION

Intrinsic motivation

Is internal and arises from within the individual.

It is the motivation to engage in a behavior because of the inherent satisfaction of the activity rather than the desire for a reward or specific outcome.

It occurs when we act without any obvious external rewards:
"We simply enjoy an activity or see it as an opportunity to explore, learn, and actualize our potentials."¹

The three main elements of intrinsic motivation are autonomy, purpose, and mastery. People are intrinsically motivated when they can act independently, feel that their efforts matter, and gain satisfaction from becoming more skilled.

TYPES OF MOTIVATION

Family motivation

Some research suggests that there is a third type of motivation: family motivation. An example of this type is going to work when you are not motivated to do so internally (no intrinsic motivation), but because it is a means to support your family financially.

family motivation as the desire to expend effort to benefit one's family. Hence, it is a form of pro-social motivation for which the beneficiary is specifically the family.

Family motivation is likely to be most relevant when an employee has dependents at home, but “family” need not only refer to spouses and children; it may also extend to parents and grandparents, aunts and uncles, cousins, or other kin.

MOTIVATION IMPORTANCE

Motivation serves as a guiding force for all human behavior. So, understanding motivation can:

Increase your efficiency as you work toward your goals

Drive you to take action

Encourage you to engage in health-oriented behaviors

Help you avoid unhealthy or maladaptive behaviors, such as risk-taking and addiction

Help you feel more in control of your life

Improve your overall well-being and happiness



COMPONENTS OF MOTIVATION

Researchers have identified three major components of motivation

1. Activation is the decision to initiate a behavior. An example of activation would be enrolling in courses in order to earn your degree.
2. Persistence is the continued effort toward a goal even though obstacles may exist. An example of persistence would be showing up for your course class even though you are tired from staying up late the night before.
3. Intensity is the concentration and vigor that goes into pursuing a goal. For example, one student might work without much effort (minimal intensity) while another student studies regularly, participates in classroom discussions, and takes advantage of research opportunities outside of class (greater intensity).



COMPONENTS OF MOTIVATION

The degree of each of these components of motivation can impact whether you achieve your goal.

Strong activation, means that you are more likely to start pursuing a goal.

Persistence and intensity will determine if you keep working toward that goal and how much effort you devote to reaching it.



HOW TO IMPROVE MOTIVATION

All people experience fluctuations in their motivation and willpower.

Sometimes you feel fired up and highly driven to reach your goals. Other times, you might feel listless or unsure of what you want or how to achieve it.

when feeling low on motivation, there are steps you can take to help increase the drive. Some things could be done to develop or improve motivation

HOW TO IMPROVE MOTIVATION

Adjust goals to focus on things that really matter to the person. Focusing on things that are highly important and will help push through challenges more than goals based on things that are low in importance.

If tackling something that feels too big or too overwhelming, break it up into smaller, more manageable steps. Then, set sights on achieving only the first step.

HOW TO IMPROVE MOTIVATION

Improve your confidence. Gaining more confidence in yourself and your skills can impact your ability to achieve your goals.

Remind yourself about what you've achieved in the past and where your strengths lie. This helps keep self-doubts from limiting your motivation.

If there are things you feel insecure about, try working on making improvements in those areas so you feel more skilled and capable.

THEORIES OF MOTIVATION

Throughout history, psychologists have proposed different theories to explain what motivates human behavior.

Instincts

The instinct theory of motivation suggests that behaviors are motivated by instincts, which are fixed and inborn patterns of behavior.

Psychologists have proposed several basic human drives that motivate behavior.

They include biological instincts that are important for an organism's survival—such as fear, cleanliness, and love.

THEORIES OF MOTIVATION

Drives and Needs

- Many behaviors such as eating, drinking, and sleeping are motivated by biology. We have a biological need for food, water, and sleep. Therefore, we are motivated to eat, drink, and sleep.
- The drive reduction theory of motivation suggests that people have these basic biological drives, and our behaviors are motivated by the need to fulfill these drives
- Abraham Maslow's hierarchy of needs is another motivation theory based on a desire to fulfill basic physiological needs. Once those needs are met, it expands to our other needs, such as those related to safety and security, social needs, self-esteem, and self-actualization

THEORIES OF MOTIVATION

Arousal Levels

- The arousal theory of motivation suggests that people are motivated to engage in behaviors that help them maintain their optimal level of arousal.
- A person with low arousal needs might pursue relaxing activities such as reading a book, while those with high arousal needs might be motivated to engage in exciting, thrill-seeking behaviors such as motorcycle racing.